19.12 Caregiver Burden*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I have not slept well for months caring for my father." **Objective** • Caregiver exhausted • Neglecting her own health	**ACTUAL** Excessive caregiving burden related to continuous care demands as evidenced by exhaustion and neglect of personal health.	• Caregiver names and uses one form of respite.	• Assess the caregiver's stress. • Share the caring among family members. • Link her to respite and community services. • Encourage her to look after her own health.	• Achieved when respite is used.
Subjective • "I feel guilty when I get angry." **Objective** • Tearful • Irritable	**ACTUAL** Maladaptive coping related to prolonged caregiving stress as evidenced by guilt and tearfulness.	• Caregiver uses two healthy ways of coping.	• Listen, and reassure her that these feelings are common. • Suggest support groups. • Teach ways to reduce stress.	• Outcome reached when she is coping.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Socially isolated • No longer visits friends	**RISK** Risk for excessive loneliness as evidenced by risk factors: social isolation of the caregiver.	• Keeps regular social contact.	• Encourage contact with friends. • Plan regular breaks. • Link her to caregiver support services.	• Considered met while contact is maintained.

*References for this care plan: [35], [94], [119], [126]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.